

1.2 Problem Statement

Document 1.2 — Problem Statement

Project: Hospital Appointment Management System **Platform:** ServiceNow (Scoped Application) **Phase:** Ideation

This document presents three empathy-based problem statements, each written from the perspective of a different persona affected by the current manual/phone-based appointment process. Each statement follows the format:

"I am [persona], I'm trying to [goal], but [obstacle], because [reason], which makes me feel [emotion]."

1. Patient Perspective

I am a patient, I'm trying to book a convenient appointment with a specific doctor, but I have no way of knowing which time slots are actually available before calling or visiting the clinic, because the clinic's availability is only known to front-desk staff and is not shared with patients in real time, which makes me feel frustrated and powerless over my own schedule.

Patients frequently call multiple times or visit in person just to ask if a slot is free, only to be told it has already been taken. When a preferred slot is unavailable, there is no structured way to join a waitlist — patients are simply told to "call back later," and cancelled slots often go unused because no one is notified when they open up. This creates unnecessary friction for a task that should be simple and self-service.

2. Doctor Perspective

I am a doctor, I'm trying to manage my daily patient queue efficiently, but I have no visibility into how many patients are booked, checked in, or likely to no-show until I am already in the middle of my shift, because appointment records are scattered across registers, phone notes, and verbal handoffs from front-desk staff, which makes me feel overwhelmed and unable to plan my day predictably.

Doctors currently define their availability informally (verbally or via a paper register), which means front-desk staff can double-book a slot without realizing it, or leave a slot open that could have gone to a waitlisted patient. Doctors have no direct way to update their own availability or see a clean, real-time view of their queue status (booked vs. checked-in vs. completed vs. no-show).

3. Hospital Front-Desk/Admin Perspective

I am a front-desk/admin staff member, I'm trying to coordinate bookings across multiple doctors and handle walk-in patients smoothly, but I have to manually cross-check paper registers or spreadsheets for every doctor before confirming a booking, because there is no centralized system showing real-time slot status across all doctors, which makes me feel anxious about making booking errors that inconvenience patients and doctors alike.

Front-desk staff act as the single point of coordination between patients and doctors, but without a shared system of record, they are prone to double-booking, missed cancellations, and lost waitlist requests. When a patient cancels by phone, there is often a delay — or complete failure — in that slot being offered to the next waiting patient, resulting in wasted doctor time and preventable patient dissatisfaction.

Summary

Across all three personas, the common thread is the **absence of a single, shared, real-time source of truth** for doctor availability and appointment status. Each persona experiences a different symptom of this same root problem — patients lack visibility, doctors lack control and foresight, and front-desk staff lack coordination confidence. This shared root cause is what the Hospital Appointment Management System is designed to solve through a centralized ServiceNow scoped application with

role-based portal access.

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